

LLMs in Finance Seminar

Presentation Handout

Two presentations per group: 45-minute paper presentation and 30-minute implementation presentation.

Component	Length	Goal
Paper presentation	45 min	Teach the paper clearly and critically, with a strong explanation of the technical contribution and why it matters for finance.
Implementation presentation	30 min	Present a working implementation of some version of the idea, with experiments, baselines, and lessons learned.

1. Paper presentation (45 minutes)

Do not paraphrase the paper slide by slide. Teach the paper, explain the main technical ideas, and assess the strengths and weaknesses.

Main section	What should be covered
Motivation and problem setting	What finance problem is being solved, why it matters, and why LLMs are relevant.
Background	Only the minimum context needed: task, data setting, benchmark, and key concepts.
Core idea	Main contribution, novelty, and overall pipeline or architecture.
Methodology	Data, modeling choices, prompting/fine-tuning/retrieval setup, experimental design, and baselines.
Results	Main findings, how the method performs, and whether the gains are meaningful.
Critical assessment	Strengths, weaknesses, assumptions, limitations, and concerns about leakage, robustness, or realism.
Relevance for finance	What the paper teaches us about LLM use in finance and where it may matter in practice.
Conclusion	Two or three takeaways the audience should remember.

Suggested time allocation

Section	Time
Motivation and background	8-10 min
Core idea and methodology	15-18 min

Results	8-10 min
Critical discussion and finance relevance	8-10 min
Conclusion / transition	2 min

2. Implementation presentation (30 minutes)

Focus on what you built. Do not repeat the paper summary. Explain what part of the idea you implemented, how you evaluated it, and what you learned.

Main section	What should be covered
Objective	State exactly what part of the paper you reproduced, adapted, or simplified.
System design	Data, model(s), prompts, retrieval/fine-tuning choices, software stack, and major simplifications.
Experimental design	Task definition, metrics, baselines, train/test split, and steps taken to avoid leakage.
Results	Main quantitative findings, comparisons with baselines, and representative examples.
Error analysis	Where the system works, where it fails, and why.
Lessons learned	Implementation challenges, reproducibility issues, and what you would improve next.

Suggested time allocation

Section	Time
Objective and setup	5-7 min
Method and experimental design	8-10 min
Results and error analysis	10-12 min
Lessons learned and conclusion	3-5 min

3. General expectations

- Use a clear structure, readable slides, and figures or diagrams where they help understanding.
- Interpret results instead of copying tables without explanation.
- Be explicit about assumptions, limitations, and possible bias or leakage.
- For the implementation, include baselines and an honest discussion of failures.
- A polished presentation helps, but rigorous thinking and critical evaluation matter more.

Recommended submission mindset: explain clearly, evaluate critically, and show evidence.